

USSR's Control Over Eastern Europe Topical Paper 1

Past Year Paper Questions 2025-2021

0470/13/O/N/25

- 8 Soviet control over Eastern Europe faced many challenges.
- (a) Who was Imre Nagy? [4]
 - (b) Why was Czechoslovakia invaded by Soviet troops in 1968? [6]
 - (c) 'Solidarity was to blame for the declining influence of the Soviet Union in Eastern Europe after 1985.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/M/J/25

- 8 The Soviet Union faced several challenges in Eastern Europe.
- (a) Describe the impact the Berlin Wall had on the people of East Berlin. [4]
 - (b) Why was Solidarity important? [6]
 - (c) 'The Soviet Union responded in the same way to unrest in Hungary and in Czechoslovakia.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/M/J/25

- 8 In the decades after the Second World War, the Soviet Union struggled to maintain control of Eastern Europe.
- (a) Describe the role played by Jaruzelski in Poland in 1981. [4]
 - (b) Why did Soviet policy towards Eastern Europe change after 1985? [6]
 - (c) 'Events in Hungary in 1956 were more of a threat to Soviet control in Eastern Europe than events in Czechoslovakia in 1968.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/F/M/25

- 8 By 1990 the Soviet Union's control over Eastern Europe had ended.
- (a) What was the Brezhnev Doctrine intended to prevent? [4]
 - (b) Why did the East German government begin the construction of the Berlin Wall in 1961? [6]
 - (c) 'The collapse of Soviet control over Eastern Europe was brought about by the policies of Gorbachev.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/O/N/24

- 8 The Soviet Union had a difficult task in maintaining control over Eastern Europe.
- (a) Describe events in Gdansk in August 1980. [4]
 - (b) Why did Solidarity grow rapidly from its formation until late 1981? [6]
 - (c) 'The collapse of communism in Eastern Europe was brought about by discontent with Soviet control.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/O/N/24

- 8 Objections in East European states to Soviet control met with resistance.
- (a) Describe the impact of the building of the Berlin Wall on the people of Berlin. [4]
 - (b) Why was there a demand for change in Czechoslovakia in 1968? [6]
 - (c) How different was the reaction of the USSR to the uprising in Hungary in 1956 from its reaction to events in Czechoslovakia in 1968? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/13/O/N/24

- 8 The Soviet Union was determined to retain control over Eastern Europe.
- (a) What was the 'Prague Spring'? [4]
 - (b) Why was Soviet control over Hungary in the early 1950s resented by Hungarians? [6]
 - (c) 'The Berlin Wall was built to stop East Germans going to the West.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/M/J/24

- 8 The Soviet Union responded to opposition in different ways.
- (a) Describe events in Eastern Europe in 1989–90. [4]
 - (b) Why was the Berlin Wall important? [6]
 - (c) 'From 1956 to 1981 the Soviet Union's reaction to opposition in Eastern Europe was to use military force.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/M/J/24

- 8 Soviet power in Eastern Europe eventually collapsed.
- (a) Who was Alexander Dubček? [4]
 - (b) Why did the Soviet Union respond violently to opposition in Hungary in 1956? [6]
 - (c) Who was more responsible for the collapse of Soviet control in Eastern Europe: Walesa or Gorbachev? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/13/M/J/24

- 8 The Soviet Union kept Eastern Europe under its control for several decades.
- (a) What was the Berlin Wall? [4]
 - (b) Why did the Soviet Union respond violently to events in Czechoslovakia in 1968? [6]
 - (c) How much of a threat was Solidarity to Soviet control in Eastern Europe? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/M/J/23

- 8 The Soviets had to deal with many problems in Eastern Europe.
- (a) What reforms did Dubček propose for Czechoslovakia in 1968? [4]
 - (b) Why was there an uprising in Hungary in 1956? [6]
 - (c) 'Soviet control over Eastern Europe collapsed because of problems in the USSR.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/13/M/J/23

- 8 Soviet control of Eastern Europe came under increasing pressure.
- (a) Describe moves against Soviet control in Eastern Europe in 1989. [4]
 - (b) Why was Dubček important? [6]
 - (c) Which was the more serious problem for the Soviet Union, Hungary in 1956 or Solidarity in 1980–81? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/O/N/22

- 8 Many measures were taken to maintain Soviet control over Eastern Europe.
- (a) What was the Brezhnev Doctrine? [4]
 - (b) Why was the Berlin Wall built? [6]
 - (c) How far do you agree that resistance to Soviet domination broke out in Hungary (1956) and Czechoslovakia (1968) for the same reasons? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/13/O/N/22

- 8 The rise of Solidarity challenged Soviet control over Eastern Europe.
- (a) What were the aims of Solidarity? [4]
 - (b) Why did the Polish government introduce Martial Law in 1981? [6]
 - (c) How far do you agree that Solidarity was the main reason for the collapse of Soviet power in Eastern Europe? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/F/M/22

- 7 During the Cold War problems for the Soviets broke out across much of Eastern Europe.
- (a) Describe the events that led to the revolt in Hungary in 1956. [4]
 - (b) Why did many Germans dislike the Berlin Wall? [6]
 - (c) 'The authorities in Poland dealt effectively with Solidarity.' How far do you agree with this statement? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/11/O/N/21

- 8 The USSR faced challenges to its control over Eastern Europe.
- (a) Describe events in Hungary in 1956. [4]
 - (b) Why was Czechoslovakia invaded in 1968? [6]
 - (c) How far do you agree that Gorbachev was to blame for the collapse of Soviet power in Eastern Europe? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/M/J/21

- 8 After decades of problems in parts of Eastern Europe, Soviet control finally collapsed.
- (a) Describe how the Soviet Union responded to the uprising in Hungary in 1956. [4]
 - (b) Why was it important for the Soviet Union to stop Dubček's reform programme in Czechoslovakia? [6]
 - (c) Are you surprised that Gorbachev made little effort to defend Soviet power in Eastern Europe? Explain your answer. [10]

0470/12/F/M/21

- 8 There were many threats to Soviet control over Eastern Europe.
- (a) Describe the activities of 'Solidarity' in Poland during the 1980s. [4]
 - (b) Why did Gorbachev do little to defend Soviet control over Eastern Europe? [6]
 - (c) Which was the more serious problem for the USSR: the events in Hungary in 1956 or the events in Czechoslovakia in 1968? Explain your answer. [10]